



Figure 5: Global apps menu



Figure 6: Universal menu bar

sync progress. In the visual improvements department, scrollbars are now 'zero-size', the icons much better, and the overall feel one of an iOS device.

Things to do after installing

First, of course, install all recommended updates via **System > Administration > Update Manager** and restart the machine.

For a pleasant Unity experience, hardware drivers must be updated, since Unity demands 3D acceleration. If Unity isn't working, go to **System > Administration > Additional Drivers** and activate the driver. If you have an nVidia graphics card, then you have to install it using a PPA, as follows:

```
sudo add-apt-repository ppa:ubuntu-x-swat/x-updates
sudo apt-get update
sudo apt-get install nvidia-current nvidia-current-modaliases
nvidia-settings
```

When you restart your system, you should be greeted with the new Unity interface.

Install Ubuntu Tweak, which enables customising Ubuntu the way you like it, from the Software Centre, or through a PPA, as follows:

```
sudo add-apt-repository ppa:tualatrix/ppa
sudo apt-get update
sudo apt-get install ubuntu-tweak
```



Figure 7: Software Centre

Basic applications you should install

What	How
GIMP, the famous image manipulation program	<code>sudo apt-get install gimp</code> in the terminal.
VLC, the popular media player with Web streaming capability	Simply search for 'vlc' in Software Centre and hit 'Install'.
Chromium, a faster Web browser	<code>sudo add-apt-repository ppa:chromium-daily/stable</code> <code>sudo apt-get update</code> <code>sudo apt-get install chromium-browser</code>
Multiget, a very nice and easy direct-downloads manager for Ubuntu	Software Centre, or terminal lovers can use: <code>sudo apt-get install multiget</code>
Bleachbit, a system cleaner that cleans out all useless packages, freeing space on the root filesystem for better performance.	Software Centre, or <code>sudo apt-get install bleachbit</code> .

If there is something you want that is not available through Software Centre, you can still download it from the Web in .deb format, and open it with `/usr/bin/gdebi-gtk` (you must have `gdebi` and `gdebi-core` installed). A package installer window appears; hit 'Install', and it's done.

I enjoyed the new improvements a lot. I suggest you take the plunge and see what's available for you in Ubuntu Linux 11.04 'Natty Narwhal'. **END** 

By: Harsh Gupta

The author is a Linux enthusiast with over five years of experience in open source, and in network and storage administration. Learning new technologies is his favourite hobby.